

Diagramatix — Quick Reminder Sheet 1

Diagram Summary

Diagramatix supports a family of diagram types, each tuned to a different modelling job. Every type shares the same smart connector routing, configurable palettes, independent typography, AI-assisted generation, and Visio round-trip. Pick the type that matches the question you are answering.

BPMN (Business Process Model & Notation) — The flagship notation for modelling *how* a business process runs: events start and stop it, tasks do the work, and gateways branch or merge the flow, all organised into pools and lanes that show who is responsible. Use it for detailed, standards-compliant process models that stakeholders, analysts, and automation tools can all read.

Flowchart — The classic, notation-light way to show a sequence of steps and decisions using the familiar ISO 5807 symbols (process rectangle, decision diamond, terminator stadium). Use it for quick procedures, work instructions, and logic that a general audience must follow without BPMN training.

State Machine — Models the *lifecycle* of a single thing: the states it can occupy and the transitions that move it between them, from an initial dot to one or more final states. Use it for order/case status, device modes, approval lifecycles, and anything best described as “what state is it in and what changes it”.

Domain (UML Class) — Captures the *information* behind a process: entities (classes), their attributes and operations, and the associations, generalisations, aggregations, and compositions between them, grouped into packages. Use it for data models, glossaries, and the conceptual structure that underpins systems and reports.

Process Context — A high-level view of a process and its surroundings: participants, teams, systems, and the boundary that frames the scope. Use it early to agree *what is in and out of scope* before drilling into detailed BPMN.

Context / Data-Flow — Shows external entities and the processes or systems they exchange information with, at the highest level of abstraction. Use it to frame a system’s boundaries and its interactions with the outside world.

Value Chain — Left-to-right chevrons representing the major end-to-end processes that create value, optionally collapsing into linked detail diagrams. Use it for executive-level process architecture and navigation across a process landscape.

ArchiMate — The enterprise-architecture standard (ArchiMate 3.1) spanning business, application, and technology layers with its full catalogue of elements and relationships. Use it to model how strategy, business processes, applications, and infrastructure fit together.

Analysis modules — Simulator, Process Mining, Risk & Control, and APQC PCF — operate on these diagrams rather than being diagram types in their own right.